

SteerCo Charter

Step 5 · Experimentation

Agenda, attendance, red/yellow/green norms, decision log, and escalation rules for running the steering committee, set once at the start, so the group isn't renegotiating how it operates every week.

How to use this

A real decision log entry names the actual number, the actual document type, the actual decision, "status update" and "open discussion" are not decisions. Set the charter once, before Sprint 1; the whole point is that the group doesn't spend meeting time re-deciding how it operates.

The charter

Attendance	Sponsor, domain focal, architect, product owner, change owner. Standing, not optional; UAT lead joins from Sprint 4.
Cadence	45 minutes, weekly, same day and time every sprint. No cancellations without a written reason to the sponsor.
RAG norms	Red or amber against the Day 90 criteria is expected and welcome. A meeting that closes all-green is a warning sign, not a success.
Agenda structure	Demo (15 min) → Metrics (10 min) → Blockers (15 min) → Decisions (5 min). Same order every week.
Escalation rule	A blocker unresolved after one week goes to the sponsor by name, not back on next week's agenda unchanged.
Decision log	Every decision gets one line: what, why, who approved, date. Kept in the RAID log, not in meeting notes no one reopens.

Example: the charter in action, Week 4

Demo	Exception queue running on real Sprint 3–4 data. Counselors saw flagged applications sorted by submission date for the first time.
Metrics	Amber: OCR accuracy on transcripts, 91% vs. 95% target. Green: verification time, 1.6 hrs avg.
Blocker	Transcript OCR needs a different extraction approach than IDs and personal statements. Architect flagged before writing more code for that document type.
Decision	Approved: extend transcript OCR work by 3 days, absorbed inside Sprint 4, no schedule change. Owner: Architect.

Sourced from the AIFT Playbook.